

# How to Participate

Phase 0 is the right moment to ask questions, raise concerns, and help shape what comes next. There is no single path to getting involved.

## Village Residents & Landowners

Your land, local knowledge, and voice are essential. Join the community consultation process and help shape the design of what is built here.

## Forestry & Energy Professionals

Technical review, feasibility input, and partnership in implementation of forest restoration and energy systems.

## Investors & Philanthropists

Phase 0 funding for feasibility studies, legal structure, and early community outreach. Impact-first approach.

## Researchers & Academics

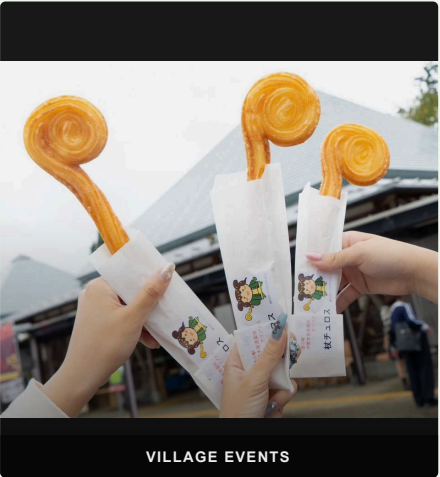
Collaborate on open data, carbon measurement, rural energy modelling, and ecological monitoring.

## Other Rural Communities

Everything built here is documented and shared openly — free for any village facing the same challenges to replicate and adapt.



JINJA FESTIVAL



VILLAGE EVENTS

Mitsue.  
ECOLOGY · ENERGY · DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE



mitsue.it

Rob Oudendijk

oudendijk.biz@gmail.com

080-2260-5966

Mitsue Village, Nara Prefecture, Japan  
Version 2.1 · May 2026



# THE MITSUE PROJECT

Ecology · Energy  
Digital Infrastructure for Rural Japan  
MITSUE VILLAGE · NARA · JAPAN

THE PROJECT

# Three Pillars

## Forest Restoration

Aging cedar monoculture replaced with native mixed forest, healing land that has been ecologically depleted for decades. Landowners begin receiving income from timber harvest from Year 2.

## Biomass CHP & Energy Resilience

Sugi forest thinnings fuel a biomass CHP system providing electricity (primary) and heat (secondary) — the forest powers the village. Solar panels and EV charging for residents and visitors complement the system, with blackout resilience built in.

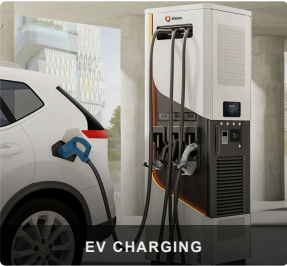
## Sustainable AI Data Center

A small, efficient digital facility inside the Mitsue Taiken Koryukan, powered entirely by local renewable energy — creating local employment and stable long-term revenue where none existed before. Phase 2 expands to a larger old factory in Mitsue.

"These are not three separate ideas — each one makes the others possible."



CEDAR FOREST



EV CHARGING



COMMUNITY

PHASE 0 · NOW OPEN

# What We're Building

The Mitsue Taiken Koryukan and its surrounding cedar forest — transformed into a living model of rural self-sufficiency for Japan and the world.

## WHY THIS PLACE?

- ✓ Taiken Koryukan available for reuse
- ✓ Productive cedar forest within reach
- ✓ Resident engineer with deep local roots since 2012
- ✓ Village leadership open to new ideas
- ✓ Proven open-data ethos from Safecast

## FUNDED BY

林野庁 forest grants · METI/NEDO biomass & rural energy grants · FIT/FIP feed-in tariff revenues · J-Credit carbon offset income · Data center service revenue · Impact investment & philanthropy

## ADVISORS

- Joi Ito** — Former Director, MIT Media Lab
- Ray Ozzie** — Former Chief Software Architect, Microsoft
- Takuo Dome** — Professor Emeritus, Osaka University · Director, Inochi Forum
- San Poisson** — Project Manager

MILESTONES

# Timeline

Benefits arrive well before Year 25 — the 25-year horizon describes full forest restoration, not how long the village waits for results.

|           |                                                                                                  |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Year 1    | Taiken Koryukan reactivated as datacenter hub; international media visibility for Mitsue Village |
| Year 2    | Landowners begin receiving income from cedar harvest                                             |
| Year 3–4  | Biomass CHP unit & EV charging stations operational; battery storage for blackout resilience     |
| Year 4–5  | Data center operational; local jobs in operations & maintenance created                          |
| Year 5–10 | Data service revenue reinvested into village and forest programmes                               |
| Year 25   | Native mixed forest established; model fully documented and shared openly worldwide              |

## About the Team

**Rob Oudendijk** — Dutch electrical engineer, resident of Mitsue since 2012. Core hardware developer for *Safecast*, the open citizen science network born after Fukushima, with over 250 million radiation measurements published openly since 2011.

A dedicated non-profit is being established with local residents, village leadership, forestry professionals, and academic partners.

